Bodo Cultural Heritage: Sijou

Category: RITUAL | Region: Assam | Status: needs_check

Bibliographic Citation & Provenance:

The Kacháris (Sidney Endle, 1911); Bathou Religious Tradition

Narrative & Cultural Documentation:

The Sijou tree (Euphorbia neriifolia / antiquorum) is the sacred living symbol of Bathou Bwrai, the supreme deity of the indigenous Bathou religion of the Bodo community. In every traditional Bodo homestead, a Sijou tree is reverently planted in the north-eastern corner of the courtyard (Sithla), paired with the sacred Tulsi plant. The plant is enclosed within a circular bamboo fence made of exactly eighteen pairs of woven bamboo splits (Khonthir), which symbolize the eighteen pairs of divine attributes and moral principles governing human conduct. During the sacred Kherai festival and domestic rituals, offerings of clean water, rice, flowers, and incense are placed at the foot of the Sijou tree.